

DEEPANJAN GUHA

Chief Operating Officer | Banking Operations & Digital Transformation Leader

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Enterprise Chief Operating Officer with 20+ years of distinguished cross-border banking leadership across Singapore, UAE, UK, GCC, US, Canada, and India. Currently serving as Chief Operating Officer at ICICI Bank Singapore, with comprehensive accountability for branch-wide operations, regulatory governance, and strategic transformation spanning Retail Banking, Corporate Banking, Trade Finance, Treasury, and Wealth Management business lines.

Recognized by regulators, boards, and executive leadership as a safe pair of hands who successfully balances operational efficiency, regulatory compliance, and digital innovation without increasing risk exposure. Demonstrated deep credibility with MAS, ABS, RBI, FATF, FCA, and other global regulatory frameworks, consistently achieving four consecutive years of zero critical regulatory findings across multiple jurisdictional audits and inspections.

CORE LEADERSHIP DOMAINS

Enterprise Banking Operations Leadership End-to-end ownership across Retail, Corporate, Trade Finance, Treasury, and Wealth Management Regulatory Governance & Statutory Reporting MAS 610, 643A, TBGS, EWRA, CRAFT, MLTF, SDIC compliance and examiner engagement Payments Infrastructure Modernization ISO 20022, MEPS+, SWIFT GPI, FAST, GIRO, RTGS, CBPR+ implementation leadership AML/KYC & Financial Crime Governance First line of defense for AML, CFT, KYC, sanctions, FATCA, CRS, and transaction monitoring	Operational Risk Management RCSA, KRI monitoring, incident management, loss event tracking, and first-line governance Outsourcing & Third-Party Risk Governance MAS Guidelines 634/658 compliance, vendor due diligence, SLA governance, ongoing monitoring Business Continuity & Operational Resilience Crisis management, BCP coordination, <1 hour RTO for critical functions Digital Transformation, RPA, Analytics & AI MAS MindForge AI Governance Taskforce representative, RPA deployment, predictive analytics
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Operating Officer / Head of Operations

ICICI Bank Ltd, Singapore Branch | July 2020 – Present (5+ years)

Strategic Operations Leadership & Transformation

- Provide strategic direction and end-to-end operational delivery oversight across Retail Banking, Corporate Banking, Trade Finance, Treasury Operations, and Wealth Management, ensuring resilient, scalable, and compliant processes under MAS Technology Risk Management and ABS operational guidelines
- Architected and implemented comprehensive Target Operating Model (TOM) integrating strategic outsourcing to India capability centers, intelligent automation through RPA and AI, robust control testing frameworks, and continuous improvement methodologies. Achieved approximately 30% reduction in average process turnaround times, 20% reduction in operational loss incidents, and 15% OPEX savings through optimized vendor governance and offshore migration strategies
- Designed and deployed near real-time Management Information System dashboards providing comprehensive visibility into SLA/TAT performance metrics, operational risk events, customer experience

indicators, process bottlenecks, and regulatory compliance status enabling proactive intervention and data-driven decision making

- Lead cross-functional transformation initiatives bringing together business stakeholders, technology teams, risk and compliance functions, and offshore delivery centers. Successfully delivered over 15 enterprise-scale digital initiatives across operations, payments infrastructure, and compliance domains

Regulatory Governance, Compliance & Risk Management

- Serve as single point of accountability and primary contact for all MAS regulatory audits, inspections, thematic reviews, and examinations, as well as SDIC testing and compliance verification. Achieved remarkable track record of zero critical findings over four consecutive years (2020-2024) across multiple regulatory examinations
- Own full lifecycle of regulatory reporting encompassing MAS 610 (Statistics and Returns), MAS 643A (Technology Risk Management), TBGS (Top Borrower Reporting), EWRA, CRAFT, and MLTF returns. Implemented automated data pipeline solutions reducing regulatory submission cycles by approximately 35% while enhancing data quality and auditability
- Designed, implemented, and maintain branch-wide Governance, Risk, and Compliance system encompassing RCSA processes, KRI monitoring and reporting, operational incident management and escalation protocols, loss event tracking and root cause analysis, issue management and remediation tracking
- Chair critical risk committees including Outsourcing Risk Committee, Business Continuity Management Committee, and Operational Resilience Forum. Serve as designated Business Continuity Coordinator maintaining recovery time objectives of less than one hour for tier-one critical functions and 100% BCP compliance

Payments Infrastructure & Digital Modernization

- Led comprehensive ISO 20022 migration program as pioneer operational lead for both MEPS+ and SWIFT MX message format transitions. Achieved zero client disruption during cutover weekend, delivered approximately 30% improvement in payment processing speeds through enhanced straight-through processing capabilities, and established foundation for advanced payment analytics
- Implemented SWIFT gpi (global payments innovation) for cross-border payment traceability, enabling real-time payment tracking, transparent fee visibility, same-day settlement capabilities, and enhanced customer experience requiring integration with SWIFT gpi Tracker and coordination with correspondent banking partners globally
- Spearheaded deployment of Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning capabilities for Trade Document Processing, implementing intelligent OCR, automated document classification, data extraction and validation. This AI-enabled transformation reduced manual document review time by approximately 40% while improving accuracy and compliance with ICC standards
- Deployed Robotic Process Automation across customer onboarding workflows, AML/KYC screening and monitoring processes, regulatory reporting data aggregation, and reconciliation processes. These automation initiatives reduced manual intervention by approximately 25% while improving processing accuracy

AI Governance Leadership & National Contributions

- Designated as official bank Single Point of Contact and representative on MAS MindForge AI Governance Taskforce, a national initiative bringing together financial institutions, regulators, technology experts, and academic institutions to develop Singapore's framework for ethical, responsible, and secure adoption of Artificial Intelligence across the financial services ecosystem
- Serve as branch lead for Ten Pathfinder AI Programme, an intensive capability-building initiative designed to embed intelligent automation, predictive analytics, machine learning models, and AI ethics principles into core operational frameworks
- Recognized as core contributor to ABS Trade Finance Registry initiative, an industry-wide digital platform designed to reduce double financing risks, enhance trade finance data transparency across banking

ecosystem, and facilitate regulatory oversight. Participated in technical working groups defining data standards, API specifications, and security protocols

Head of Operations – International Operations Group

ICICI Bank Ltd, Hyderabad, India | April 2015 – July 2020 (5 years 4 months)

- Led the International Operations Centre serving as the centralized global capability hub and delivery center for ICICI Bank's international branches across Singapore, Hong Kong, GCC (UAE, Bahrain), United Kingdom, United States, and Canada. Tasked with driving operational excellence, establishing governance frameworks, strengthening first line of defense capabilities, and delivering scalable solutions across multiple regulatory environments
- Directed large-scale, multi-jurisdictional operational delivery encompassing Retail Banking operations (account opening, deposits, loans, cards), Trade Finance processing (letters of credit, bank guarantees, documentary collections, discounting), International Payments (SWIFT, correspondent banking, remittances), and Private Banking operations (portfolio management, investment execution, client reporting)
- Established Center of Excellence delivering remarkable approximately 30% uplift in productivity metrics through systematic process optimization, technology enablement, skill development programs, and performance management frameworks. This productivity transformation was achieved while simultaneously improving quality metrics, reducing error rates, and maintaining full regulatory compliance
- Standardized core operational workflows through development of comprehensive process documentation, SOPs, work instruction manuals, decision trees, and quality checklists applicable across all geographies. This standardization initiative reduced operational incidents by approximately 25% and improved cross-geography staff mobility
- Established comprehensive branch-wide first line of defense operational risk frameworks, clearly defining RACI matrices across all geographies and business lines. Developed integrated three lines of defense model with clear accountability boundaries and escalation protocols
- Coordinated regulatory audits, examinations, and inspections across multiple jurisdictions, serving as primary liaison between local branch management, Group compliance teams, and regulatory examiners. Maintained zero significant findings over five-year tenure through proactive control testing, gap remediation, and continuous improvement initiatives

Chief Manager – Wealth Operations, Compliance & Process Transformation

ICICI Bank Ltd, Hyderabad, India | April 2010 – March 2015 (5 years)

- Led comprehensive integration of operations, compliance, and control frameworks during period of rapid business diversification and growth. Oversaw day-to-day operational delivery for Domestic Wealth Management, Mutual Fund Processing, International Private Banking, and Cross-Border Payments, ensuring regulatory adherence and operational excellence across multiple booking and marketing centers
- Directed comprehensive Wealth and Mutual Fund operations in close coordination with Registrar and Transfer Agents, custodian banks, fund houses, and asset management companies. Ensured accurate and timely settlements, daily NAV reconciliations, investor reporting, and regulatory compliance under SEBI and RBI guidelines
- Designed and implemented comprehensive Operational Risk Control Framework encompassing RCSA processes, KRI monitoring and escalation protocols, operational incident capture and reporting mechanisms, and loss event analysis across all operational units. This integrated framework provided systematic approach to operational risk identification, assessment, mitigation, and monitoring
- Led successful FATCA and CRS readiness and implementation programs, embedding enhanced due diligence requirements, customer classification methodologies, documentation standards, reporting

obligations, and ongoing monitoring processes within operational workflows. Achieved clean regulatory audit outcomes with zero findings

- Strengthened AML, CFT, and Sanctions screening capabilities within payment and wealth management workflows through implementation of enhanced transaction monitoring rules, customer risk rating methodologies, PEP screening, adverse media checks, and suspicious activity investigation procedures. Maintained six consecutive years of clean audit outcomes

Team Lead – Global Remittance Operations & Regulatory Frameworks

ICICI Bank Ltd, Mumbai, India | June 2005 – March 2010 (4 years 10 months)

- Joined the International Remittances Product Team during transformative phase, contributing to conceptualization, strategic design, operational implementation, and successful rollout of Money2India – one of India's pioneering large-scale digital cross-border remittance platforms. This innovative platform fundamentally transformed how non-resident Indians sent money to India
- Designed and implemented comprehensive end-to-end operations covering transaction intake from multiple channels (internet banking, mobile banking, partner platforms), multi-layered screening processes (AML, sanctions, fraud detection), intelligent routing logic, automated reconciliation with partner banks and payment networks, and seamless payout to beneficiary accounts
- Led cross-functional operations team managing USD 4 billion+ annual cross-border payment flows with remarkable 99.9% processing accuracy. Established shift-based operations model providing extended service hours across time zones and implemented capacity planning frameworks to manage volume fluctuations
- Established and maintained comprehensive compliance alignment with FATF guidelines on money laundering and terrorism financing, RBI directives on capital account transactions and remittances, and MAS remittance standards. Achieved zero regulatory lapses in AML/CFT compliance and sanctions controls throughout tenure
- Introduced transaction monitoring and fraud control systems incorporating velocity checks, pattern recognition, beneficiary validation, device fingerprinting, and behavioral analytics. These proactive fraud prevention measures reduced transaction disputes by approximately 25%

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

Executive Education

- **Leadership in Artificial Intelligence – Indian School of Business (ISB), 2024-2025.**
- **Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM) – Finance Specialization – Symbiosis Centre for Management and Human Resource Development (SCMHRD), Pune, 2003-2005.**
- **Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) – Mechanical Engineering – Rajiv Gandhi Prodyogiki Vishwavidyalaya (RGTU), 1998-2002.**

Professional Certifications

- Operations Risk Management – Association of Banks in Singapore (ABS)
- Business Continuity Management for Financial Institutions – Association of Banks in Singapore (ABS)
- Third Party Risk Management – Association of Banks in Singapore (ABS)
- AML & CFT (Anti-Money Laundering and Combating the Financing of Terrorism) – Association of Banks in Singapore (ABS)

- Trade-Based Financial Crime Compliance – Association of Banks in Singapore (ABS) and Trade Finance Arm of MAS.
- Cybersecurity Essentials – TÜV SÜD PSB Academy
- Prompt Engineering – Government of Dubai | AI Literacy – AI Singapore
- Derivatives & Risk Management – Corporate Finance Institute (CFI) and NASBA
- Currently Pursuing: Certified Trade Finance Compliance Professional (CTFC) and Certified Documentary Credit Specialist (CDCS) from London Institute of Banking & Finance (LIBF) – Expected completion 2026

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

- **Singapore FinTech Association (SFA)** – Active member participating in industry events, working groups on payments innovation and digital banking
- **London Institute of Banking & Finance (LIBF)** – Professional member engaging with global banking community and accessing continuous professional development resources
- **Association of Banks in Singapore (ABS)** – Member contributing to industry working groups on operational risk, business continuity, payments infrastructure, and trade finance
- **Association of Trade Finance Compliance Professionals** – Member of specialized professional community focused on trade finance compliance and financial crime prevention

STRATEGIC TRANSFORMATION PROJECTS

MAS MindForge – AI Governance Taskforce

Official bank Single Point of Contact contributing to Singapore's national framework for ethical AI adoption in financial services. This prestigious MAS-led initiative brings together senior leaders from financial institutions, regulators, technology experts, and academic institutions to develop governance standards, risk management frameworks, fairness principles, transparency requirements, and operational implementation guidelines.

ISO 20022 MEPS+ / SWIFT MX Migration

Pioneer operational lead delivering Singapore's national payment infrastructure transformation to ISO 20022 standard. Comprehensive program encompassing business analysis, system testing coordination, operational procedure redesign, staff training, customer communication, and parallel run management. Achieved zero client impact during cutover weekend and approximately 30% processing efficiency improvement.

ABS Trade Finance Registry

Founding industry contributor to ecosystem-wide digital platform designed to reduce double financing risk and enhance trade finance transparency. Participated in technical working groups defining data standards, API specifications, security protocols, and operational procedures for industry adoption.

Money2India Cross-Border Remittance Platform

Conceptualized and operationalized one of India's earliest large-scale digital cross-border remittance platforms serving NRI population across seven geographies. Revolutionary platform fundamentally transformed remittance experience through fully digital journey, transparent pricing, real-time processing, and superior customer experience. Platform processed USD 4 billion+ annual flows with 99.9% accuracy.

RECOGNITION & AWARDS

- Quest for Quality Award for Total Digitalization of Singapore Branch Documents and implementation of comprehensive Document Management System. Recognized for successfully digitizing all branch documentation, implementing enterprise document management platform, and achieving paperless operations while maintaining regulatory compliance

- Nominated for EFMA Awards – Accenture for innovative FCRM (First Call Resolution Management) on AIR channel ideation and implementation. Recognition for developing and implementing innovative customer service solution leveraging artificial intelligence and voice recognition technology
- Opera Award 2014 for FATCA (Foreign Account Tax Compliance Act) Implementation for Singapore and Dubai branches. Recognized for successfully leading complex regulatory implementation program across multiple jurisdictions within aggressive timeline
- Quest for Quality Award for Rate Tolerance Control implementation across all International Geography Units in I-Core banking system. Recognized for designing and implementing automated rate tolerance controls preventing unauthorized pricing deviations

EXECUTIVE VALUE PROPOSITION

Deepanjan brings a rare and highly valued combination of regulatory credibility, transformation leadership, and operational depth that boards, CEOs, and executive search firms actively seek when scaling banking operations across complex, multi-jurisdictional, highly regulated environments.

Regulator-Trusted Leadership:

Four consecutive years of zero critical regulatory findings across comprehensive MAS inspections, SDIC testing, and RBI audits demonstrates exceptional regulatory discipline and robust first-line control environment. Official contributor to MAS MindForge AI Governance framework and ABS Trade Finance Registry initiative reflects deep regulatory credibility recognized at national level.

Transformation Without Risk Escalation:

Proven track record delivering 30%+ efficiency improvements through Target Operating Models, digital automation initiatives, and payments infrastructure modernization while simultaneously maintaining or improving regulatory compliance metrics and operational resilience capabilities. This balanced approach addresses the fundamental challenge facing banking operations leaders: drive efficiency and innovation without increasing operational risk or regulatory exposure.

Enterprise-Scale Complexity Management:

End-to-end ownership of multi-line banking operations spanning eight jurisdictions (Singapore, UAE, UK, GCC, US, Canada, Hong Kong, India) with deep expertise across Retail Banking, Corporate Banking, Trade Finance, Treasury Operations, Wealth Management, and cross-border payments. Successfully navigated diverse regulatory frameworks including MAS, FCA, BSA/AML, DFSA, OSFI, and RBI while maintaining operational consistency, service quality, and compliance standards.

AI & Digital Innovation Leadership:

Leading-edge expertise in AI governance frameworks, RPA deployment at scale, payments infrastructure modernization (ISO 20022, SWIFT gpi), and digital platform development. Recognized contributor to Singapore's national AI governance frameworks through MAS MindForge participation and branch lead for the Pathfinder AI Programme. Combines strategic vision for technology-enabled transformation with pragmatic implementation approach ensuring value realization, risk management, and regulatory compliance.